

How to apply and re-apply for funding?



Lei Cong
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Outline



Part I

Build a Solid Proposal

Structure, process, and essential components

Part II

Make Reviewers Want to Fund It

Lessons from Joshua Schimel (2012)

Part III

Re-apply and Improve

Turn feedback into a stronger proposal

Part I

Build a Solid Proposal

Various funding opportunities

- DAAD Travel
- Helmholtz-OCPC
- DAAD PRIME
- Stufe I / RMU
- MSCA
- DFG individual
- KT boost
- Humboldt
- Fondazione Antonio Madonna ETS
- Enrico Fermi Fellowships



Where should a grant writer start?

- ☐ Set up your Pre-Submission Review Committee
- ☐ Seek constructive criticism of your idea
- ☐ Complete Specific Objectives + Significance of Expected Research Contribution
- ☐ Prepare Research Method/Approach for the Objectives
- ☐ Prepare Innovation + Importance of Problem + Rigor of Scientific Background

Part II Make Reviewers Want to Fund It

Lessons from Joshua Schimel, Writing Science (2012)

1 Design for an impatient reader.

A reviewer is not your collaborator.
Make the reader's job easy.



2 The first two pages are a triage test

A good design cannot rescue a boring question.

NO



MAYBE



- ❖ Make the question exciting.
- ❖ Then prove the plan is feasible.

3 Make the reviewer curious

Curiosity is the acceptable emotion in science.

Weak:

"Here is more information."



Strong:

"I need to know the answer."

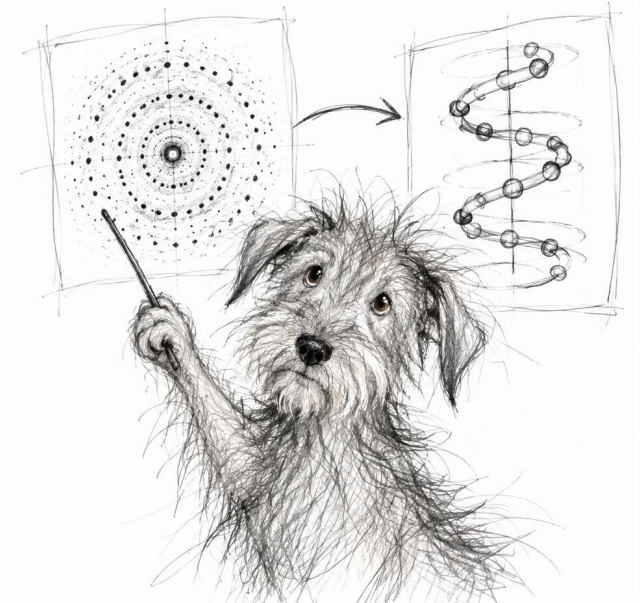


- ❖ Ask a question that can be wrong.
- ❖ Give one panelist a reason to advocate.

4 Data are not the story



**Don't sell the instrument.
Sell the understanding.**





End strong

- The last paragraph is where the story pays off.



What will
this project
change?

- ✓ Return to the big problem.
- ✓ Summarize the challenge and action.
- ✓ Leave reviewers with the resolution.

Problem → Project → Understanding

Successful and failed funding applications



Good ideas can change the world.



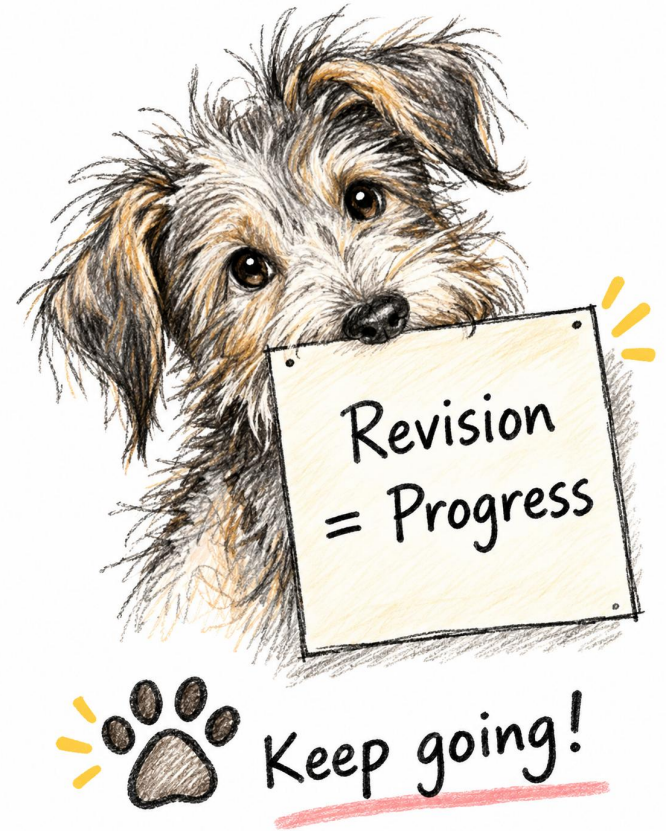
Good science needs good writing.

Part III Re-apply and Improve

1 Make a clean version.

2 Response to the previous comments.

3 Figures are often the best way to clearly convey your idea.



References and Further Reading

1

Joshua Schimel (2012)

Writing Science: How to Write Papers That Get Cited and Proposals That Get Funded. Oxford University Press.

2

Gomez-Cambronero et al. (2012)

Writing a first grant proposal. Nature Immunology 13, 105–108. doi: 10.1038/ni.2183

3

Julie Gould (2019)

How to plan a successful grant application. Nature Careers / Working Scientist. doi: 10.1038/d41586-019-00103-2

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Grant application essentials. Nature Careers / Working Scientist. doi: 10.1038/d41586-019-00197-8

